



Study Together

John 1: A Guided Journey Through Scripture



Engage the Word

This isn't just a study plan. It's spiritual muscle memory. Each day, you're guided through Scripture in a way that forms how you observe, interpret, and apply God's Word—naturally, over time.

Before you begin today's study, read John 1 in your Bible.

If you're logged into Project 3|26, open the passage in the **NASB translation right on the platform** (our recommended version).

Otherwise, use any trusted Bible you have.

Read it slowly—twice if you can. Let the words sink in, and ask God to prepare your heart for what you'll discover today.



Setting the Scene

John opens with the most profound statement in all of Scripture: "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God" (v. 1). This echoes Genesis 1:1 ("In the beginning God created"), but John goes further back—before creation, the Word already existed. The Word (Logos in Greek) is the eternal Son, the agent of creation, the life and light of humanity.

Then comes the staggering claim: "The Word became flesh, and dwelt among us" (v. 14). The Greek word for "dwelt" is *eskēnōsen*—literally "tabernacled" or "pitched His tent." John is saying Jesus is the new Tabernacle. In Exodus, God's glory filled the Tabernacle and dwelt among Israel. Now God's glory takes on flesh and moves into the neighborhood. God didn't send a messenger. He didn't make a guest appearance. He relocated. He tabernacled among us.

But here's the tragedy: "He came to His own, and those who were His own did not receive Him" (v. 11). The Light invaded darkness, and the world He created didn't recognize Him. Israel, His covenant people, rejected Him. Yet to those who did receive Him—who believed in His name—He gave the right to become children of God (v. 12). Belief creates family. Reception grants adoption.

John the Baptist appears as a witness to the Light. He's not the Light—he points to Jesus. When he sees Jesus, he declares: "Behold, the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world!" (v. 29). This is Passover language meets Isaiah 53. Jesus is the sacrificial Lamb whose blood will deliver God's people from slavery to sin.

The chapter closes with Jesus calling His first disciples. Andrew and another disciple (likely John himself) follow Jesus and ask, "Rabbi, where are You staying?" Jesus responds: "Come, and you will see" (vv. 38-39). Discipleship begins with an invitation to come and see where Jesus dwells. They spend the day with Him. Everything changes.

Observe

Key Verses:

The Word Was God (vv. 1-3): "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. He was in the beginning with God. All things came into being through Him, and apart from Him nothing came into being that has come into being."

Life and Light (vv. 4-5): "In Him was life, and the life was the Light of men. The Light shines in the darkness, and the darkness did not comprehend it."

John the Baptist's Testimony (vv. 6-8): "There came a man sent from God, whose name was John. He came as a witness, to testify about the Light, so that all might believe through him. He was not the Light, but he came to testify about the Light."

The True Light (vv. 9-11): "There was the true Light which, coming into the world, enlightens every man. He was in the world, and the world was made through Him, and the world did not know Him. He came to His own, and those who were His own did not receive Him."

The Right to Become Children of God (vv. 12-13): "But as many as received Him, to them He gave the right to become children of God, even to those who believe in His name, who were born, not of blood nor of the will of the flesh nor of the will of man, but of God."

The Word Became Flesh (v. 14): "And the Word became flesh, and dwelt among us, and we saw His glory, glory as of the only begotten from the Father, full of grace and truth."

The Lamb of God (v. 29): "The next day he saw Jesus coming to him and said, 'Behold, the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world!'"

Come and See (vv. 38-39): "And Jesus turned and saw them following, and said to them, 'What do you seek?' They said to Him, 'Rabbi (which translated means Teacher), where are You staying?' He said to them, 'Come, and you will see.' So they came and saw where He was staying; and they stayed with Him that day."

Interpret

The Word Was God—Then Became Flesh

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God" (v. 1). This is Trinity language. The Word (Jesus) was *with* God (distinct person) and *was* God (same essence). He's not a created being—He existed before creation. "All things came into being through Him" (v. 3). Jesus is the agent of creation. Everything that exists came through Him.

Then verse 14 drops the bomb: "The Word became flesh, and dwelt among us." The eternal God took on human nature. The Creator entered creation. The infinite became finite. This is the incarnation—God didn't stop being God, but He added humanity to deity. And the word "dwelt" (Greek *eskēnōsen*) means "tabernacled."

In Exodus 40:34-35, God's glory filled the Tabernacle so intensely that Moses couldn't enter. The Tabernacle was where heaven met earth, where God's presence dwelt among His people. Now John says Jesus is the new Tabernacle. God's glory isn't in a tent anymore—it's in flesh. Jesus is where heaven meets earth. He's Immanuel, "God with us." And unlike the Exodus Tabernacle that moved from place to place, Jesus tabernacled among us permanently. God didn't visit—He moved into the neighborhood.

Light Shines in Darkness, and Darkness Didn't Get It

"The Light shines in the darkness, and the darkness did not comprehend it" (v. 5). The word "comprehend" can mean "understand" or "overcome." Both are true. Darkness didn't understand the Light (blind to truth), and darkness couldn't overcome the Light (Jesus wins).

"He was in the world, and the world was made through Him, and the world did not know Him" (v. 10). This is tragic. The Creator walked into His creation, and nobody recognized Him. You'd think the universe would bow. Instead, it shrugged. Worse: "He came to His own, and those who were His own did not receive Him" (v. 11). Israel, the covenant people who had the Scriptures, the prophets, the promises—they rejected Him.

But here's the hope: "But as many as received Him, to them He gave the right to become children of God" (v. 12). Reception changes everything. You don't have to be born into the right family. You don't need the right bloodline. You need to receive Jesus. And when you do, you're born again—"not of blood nor of the will of the flesh nor of the will of man, but of God" (v. 13). This is spiritual birth. God births you into His family when you believe.

The Lamb of God Who Takes Away Sin

When John the Baptist sees Jesus, he doesn't say "Behold, the Teacher" or "the Healer" or "the King." He says, "Behold, the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world!" (v. 29). This is

Passover imagery. In Exodus 12, every household sacrificed a lamb, spread its blood on the doorposts, and death passed over them. The lamb died so they could live.

But John also echoes Isaiah 53:7: "Like a lamb that is led to slaughter...He was oppressed and He was afflicted." Jesus is the sacrificial Lamb whose death will deliver humanity from sin. Not just cover sin (like the Old Testament sacrifices), but *take it away*. One Lamb. One sacrifice. Final atonement. And notice: He takes away "the sin of the world"—not just Israel's sin, but humanity's. This is global salvation.

"Come and See" — Discipleship Begins with Following

When Andrew and John follow Jesus, He asks, "What do you seek?" (v. 38). They respond, "Rabbi, where are You staying?" They're not asking for a street address—they're asking permission to spend time with Him. Jesus says, "Come, and you will see" (v. 39).

Discipleship starts here: *Come*. Follow. Spend time. See where He dwells. They stayed with Him that day, and everything changed. Andrew immediately finds his brother Simon and says, "We have found the Messiah" (v. 41). One day with Jesus, and they're convinced. That's the power of His presence.

Jesus doesn't start with a theology lecture. He starts with "Come." Relationship precedes doctrine. Presence transforms before teaching does. And the invitation is still open: Come and see where Jesus dwells.

Apply

Have you received Jesus, or just acknowledged His existence?

Do you believe God tabernacled among us—moved into the neighborhood permanently—or do you treat Him like a distant deity?

Are you living in darkness that doesn't comprehend the Light, or have you been born again by God?

Have you recognized Jesus as the Lamb of God who takes away *your* sin?

When Jesus says "Come and see," are you following, or are you standing at a distance?

Do you spend time with Jesus, or just talk about Him?

Quote of the Chapter

"The Word became flesh and tabernacled among us—God didn't visit, He moved into the neighborhood." — Project 3|26

Closing Prayer

Father, thank You for John 1, which reveals that the eternal Word became flesh and tabernacled among us, that Light invaded darkness and darkness couldn't overcome it, and that as many as receive Jesus are born into Your family. Forgive us for treating You like a distant visitor instead of the God who moved in permanently, for living in darkness when You've given us Light, and for acknowledging Jesus without truly receiving Him.

Help us see that You didn't send a message—You became the message. Remind us that we weren't born into Your family by blood or human will, but by Your Spirit. Open our eyes to recognize Jesus as the Lamb of God who takes away our sin. When You say "Come and see," give us courage to follow and spend time in Your presence. Make us people who don't just know about You, but know You. Through Christ, the Word made flesh, Amen.

Memory Verse Option

John 1:14

"And the Word became flesh, and dwelt among us, and we saw His glory, glory as of the only begotten from the Father, full of grace and truth."

Community Connection

How does your community help each other move from acknowledging Jesus to truly receiving Him?

Are you pointing people to the Light like John the Baptist, or are you trying to be the light yourselves?

Do you spend time with Jesus together, or just talk about theology in the abstract?

How can you help each other see that God tabernacled among us—He's not distant, He's here?